

ter and the next quarter. We have taken a number of steps such as substituting rare earth magnets with ferrite magnets,” he said. According the International Market Analysis, Research and Consulting Group, the domestic ferrite magnet market was 61,650 tonnes in 2024; it is expected to reach 74,840 tonnes by 2033.

Notably, amidst the crisis, several original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) have started working towards rare earth magnet-free motors. US-based start-up Conifer.io and homegrown Sterling GTake Mobility plan to introduce a ferrite magnet motor in the next few quarters.

“Rare earths are the new oil. We can’t electrify the world using globally constrained materials. That’s why we took a rare earth-agnostic approach,” says Ankit Somani, co-founder, Conifer.io. The company is in talks with 13 domestic automobile manufacturers for supplying ferrite magnet motors.

Jaideep Wadhwa, Managing Director, Sterling GTake Electric Mobility, a subsidiary of Sterling Tools Ltd, says the challenge isn’t building a motor without rare earths, it’s in meeting the performance and size expectations without them. The company will manufacture ferrite magnet motors at its Faridabad plant and plans to start supplying OEMs in the next 18-20 months. “We are currently engaged with customers across two-wheeler, four-wheeler, and commercial vehicle segments. Our focus is auto and EVs but we’re open to aerospace and industrial applications as well,” says Wadhwa.

Conifer.io plans to make ferrite magnet motors available to OEMs by the next quarter. “We buy ferrite magnets off the shelf. We use magnets which are 86% rust-free. We have a 100% localised supply chain in India across magnets,” says Somani.

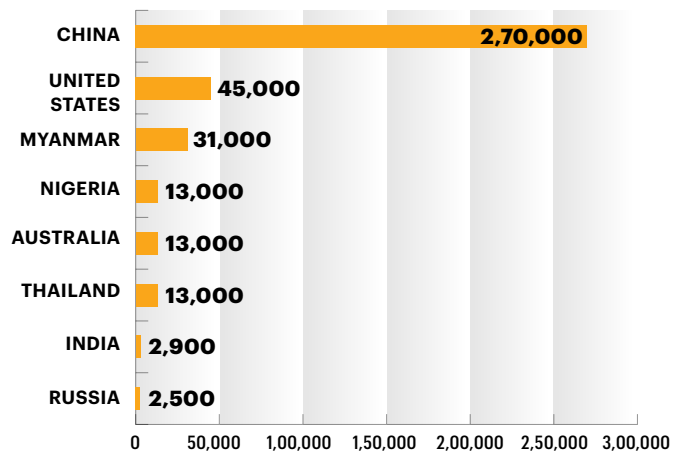
BRINGING FERRITE

The renewed interest in ferrite magnets may seem surprising at first. They have been around for decades and were widely used in various applications but were largely overshadowed by neodymium magnets. Consid-



THE CHINA FACTOR

• The country accounts for about 69% of rare earth magnet reserves • At present, it produces 2,70,000 metric tonnes of rare earth magnets



NOTE FIGURES SHOW PRODUCTION, IN METRIC TONNES
SOURCE US GEOLOGICAL SURVEY

GLOBAL PRODUCTION SHARE

